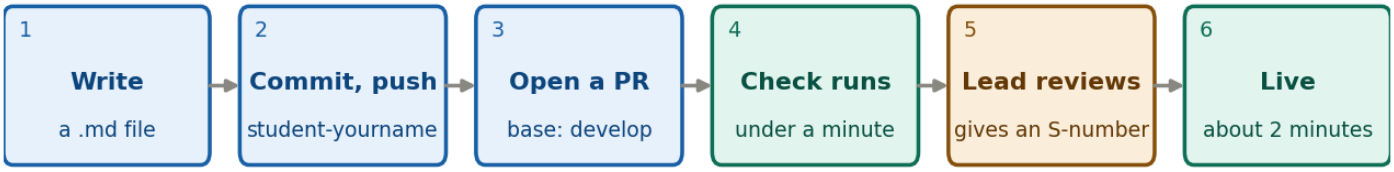
# From note to live page

NSDF-Data student cheat-sheet · version 6, 20 October 2026

A one-page reminder. The full steps are in guide 6, writing a note and guide 7, publishing a note. **Nothing is public until your lead merges your pull request (PR).**




*Blue: you. Teal: GitHub, automatically. Amber: your lead. A PR is a page on GitHub that asks to add your branch to the project.*

**Before you push**

- Your note is `notes/src/your-note-name.md`, your pictures are in `notes/src/img/`, the header is complete, and it says `id: "TBD"`.
- Every link to your code is pinned to a **commit hash**: not `develop`, `main` or `COMMIT`. Remove the template's `img/example.png` line, and any <u>, <sup>, <sub> or  tags.
- With your environment active, run `python tools/check_note.py notes/src/your-note-name.md`. It runs all the note checks: the structure and the pinned links must be fine, and it lists the numbers in your text that are not in your notebook's output.

**Commands**, from the `NSDF-Data` folder, on your own branch:

```
git checkout student-yourname
git add notes/src/your-note-name.md notes/src/img
git status              # only your note and its pictures? no .bin files, no idx folder?
git commit -m "Add note: your title"
git push -u origin student-yourname
```

Then open the repository on github.com, click **Compare & pull request**, check that the **base** is `develop`, and click **Create pull request**.

**If the check says…** (click **Details** on the check to read it)

| Message | What to do |
|---|---|
| `header field 'X' is missing or empty` | Fill in that line of the header. |
| `status must be one of ...` | Use exactly *In progress*, *Complete* or *Superseded (reference/link)*. |
| `notebook link pinned to 'master'`, or `placeholder COMMIT is still in the note` | Use the real commit hash. |
| `raw HTML tag <u>` (or <sup>, <sub>, ) | Remove the formatting, keep the words. |
| `picture not found` | Check the file name, and that it is in `notes/src/img/`. |

Fix it on your branch, commit and push again. The PR updates itself and the check runs again.

**After that.** Your lead reads the note, may comment on the PR (answer there), and gives it a note number when it is ready. About two minutes after the merge your page is live, in the **Analysis Notes** table on the front page, in order of its number. To change a published note, first run `git switch student-yourname && git pull origin develop` and check that the header still has your note number (not `TBD`); then commit, push and open a new PR, update the date, and never delete a note to hide a mistake.

**Never** work on `main` or `develop`, or commit data (`.bin` files, the `idx` folder) or other people's notes. Stuck?

Write to Anthony Villano, anthony.villano@ucdenver.edu, with the PR number, the check's message and the step you are on.